Chapter 4

Enhanced Entity-Relationship (EER) Modeling

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Chapter Outline

- EER stands for Enhanced ER or Extended ER
- EER Model Concepts
  - Includes all modeling concepts of basic ER
  - Additional concepts:
    - subclasses/superclasses
    - specialization/generalization
    - categories (UNION types)
    - attribute and relationship inheritance
  - These are fundamental to conceptual modeling
- The additional EER concepts are used to model applications more completely and more accurately
  - EER includes some object-oriented concepts, such as inheritance

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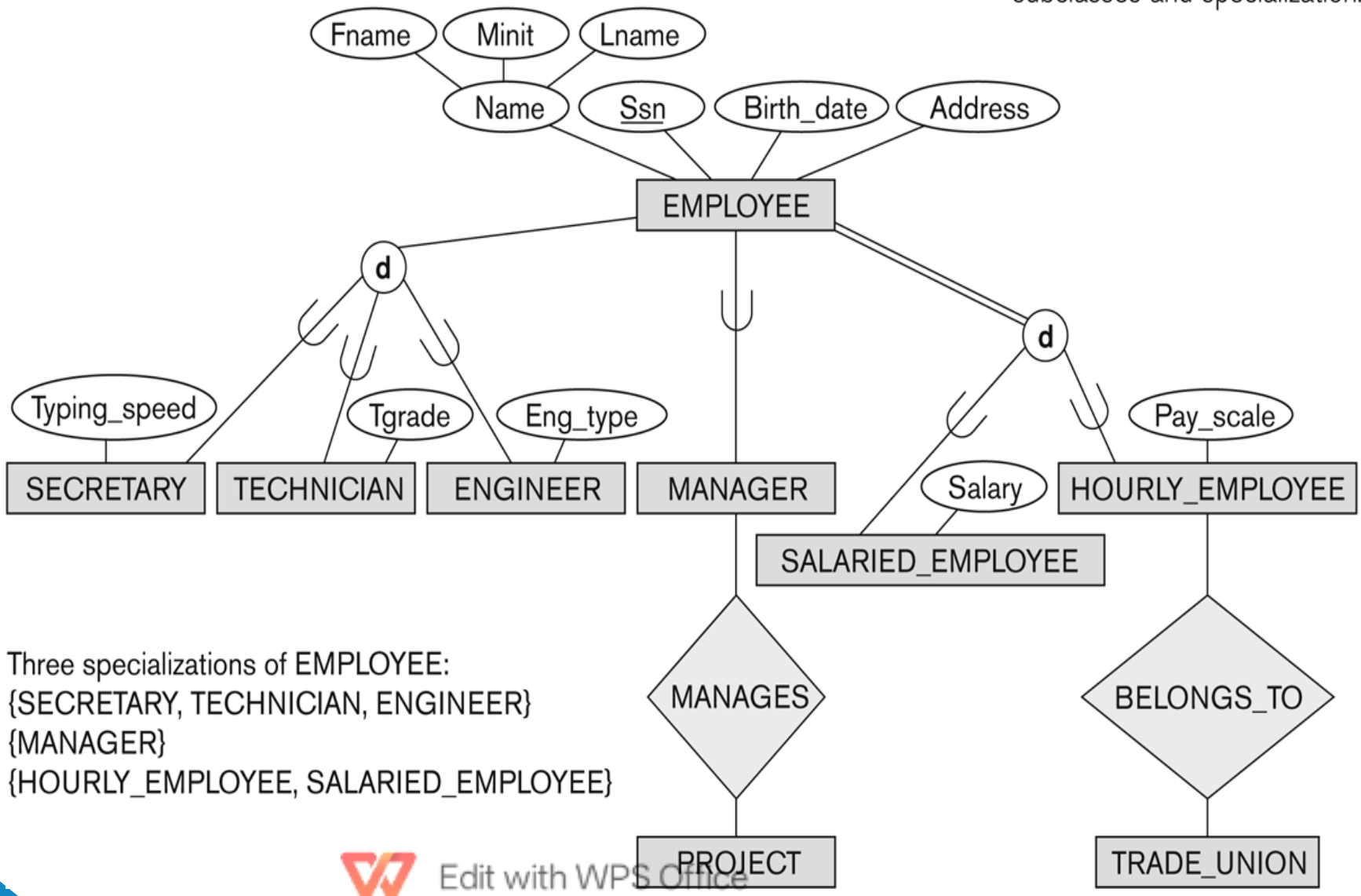
Subclasses and Superclasses (1)

- An entity is defined by attributes it possesses and relationship types in which it participates.
- An entity type may have additional meaningful subgroupings of its entities
  - Example: EMPLOYEE may be further grouped into:
    - SECRETARY, ENGINEER, TECHNICIAN, ...
      - Based on the EMPLOYEE's Job
    - MANAGER
      - EMPLOYEEs who are managers
    - SALARIED_EMPLOYEE, HOURLY_EMPLOYEE
      - Based on the EMPLOYEE's method of pay
- EER diagrams extend ER diagrams to represent these additional subgroupings, called *subclasses* or *subtypes*

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Subclasses and Superclasses

Figure 4.1
EER diagram notation to represent subclasses and specialization.



Three specializations of EMPLOYEE:
{SECRETARY, TECHNICIAN, ENGINEER}
{MANAGER}
{HOURLY_EMPLOYEE, SALARIED_EMPLOYEE}

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Subclasses and Superclasses (2)

- Each of these subgroupings is a subset of EMPLOYEE entities
- Each is called a subclass of EMPLOYEE
- EMPLOYEE is the superclass for each of these subclasses
- These are called superclass/subclass relationships:
  - EMPLOYEE/SECRETARY
  - EMPLOYEE/TECHNICIAN
  - EMPLOYEE/MANAGER
  - ...

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Subclasses and Superclasses (3)

These are also called IS-A relationships

- SECRETARY IS-A EMPLOYEE, TECHNICIAN IS-A EMPLOYEE, ...
- Note: An entity that is member of a subclass represents the same real-world entity as some member of the superclass:
  - An entity cannot exist in the database merely by being a member of a subclass; it must also be a member of the superclass

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Subclasses and Superclasses (4)

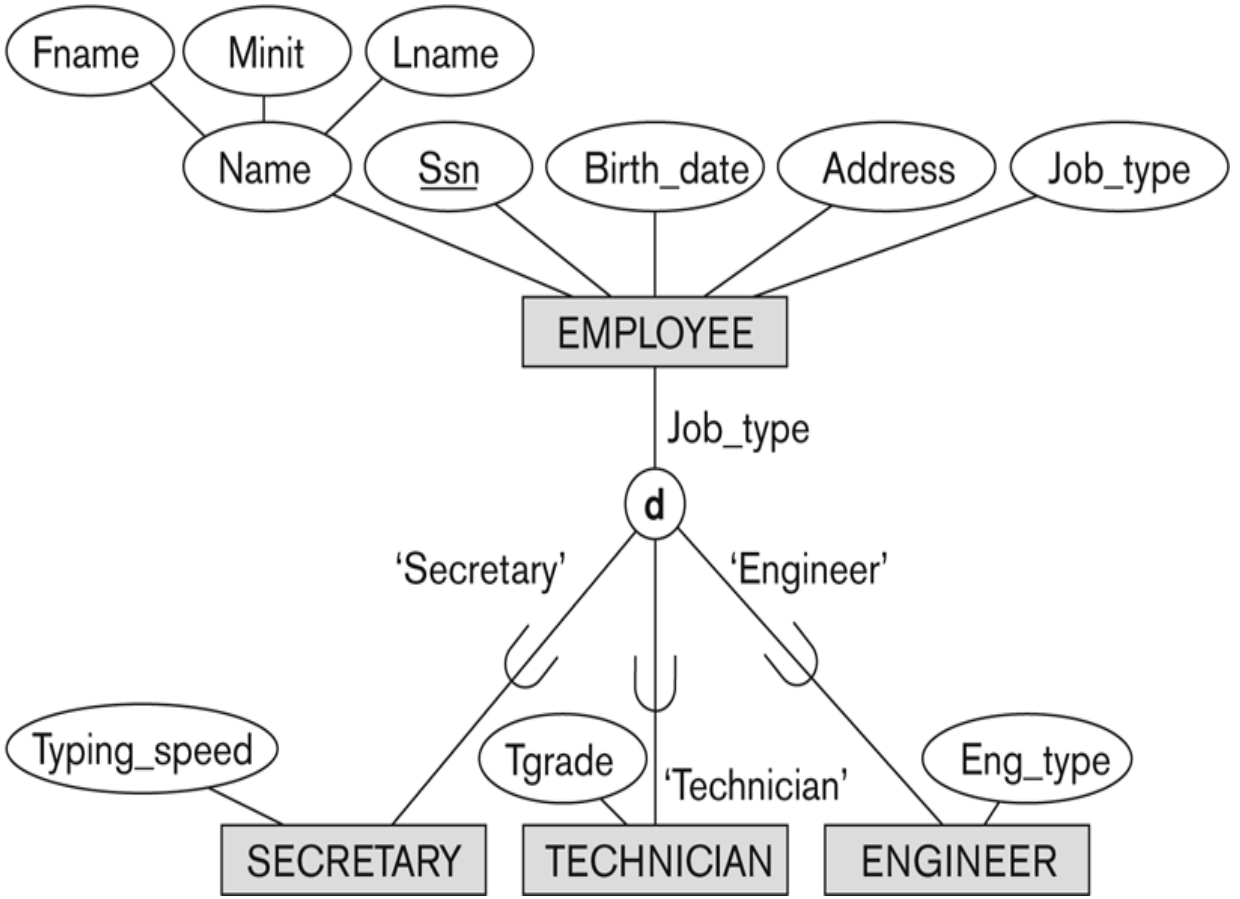
A member of the superclass can be optionally included as a member of any number of its subclasses

- Examples:
  - A salaried employee who is also an engineer belongs to the two subclasses:
    - ENGINEER, and
    - SALARIED_EMPLOYEE
  - A salaried employee who is also an engineering manager belongs to the three subclasses:
    - MANAGER, ENGINEER, and
    - SALARIED_EMPLOYEE
- It is not necessary that every entity in a superclass be a member of some subclass

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Representing Specialization in EER Diagrams

Figure 4.4
EER diagram notation for an attribute-defined specialization on Job_type.



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Attribute Inheritance in Superclass / Subclass Relationships

- An entity that is member of a subclass *inherits*
  - All attributes of the entity as a member of the superclass
  - All relationships of the entity as a member of the superclass
- Example:
  - In the previous slide, SECRETARY (as well as TECHNICIAN and ENGINEER) inherit the attributes Name, SSN, ..., from EMPLOYEE
  - Every SECRETARY entity will have values for the inherited attributes

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Specialization (1)

- Specialization is the process of defining a set of subclasses of a superclass
- The set of subclasses is based upon some distinguishing characteristics of the entities in the superclass
  - Example: {SECRETARY, ENGINEER, TECHNICIAN} is a specialization of EMPLOYEE based upon *job type.*
    - May have several specializations of the same superclass

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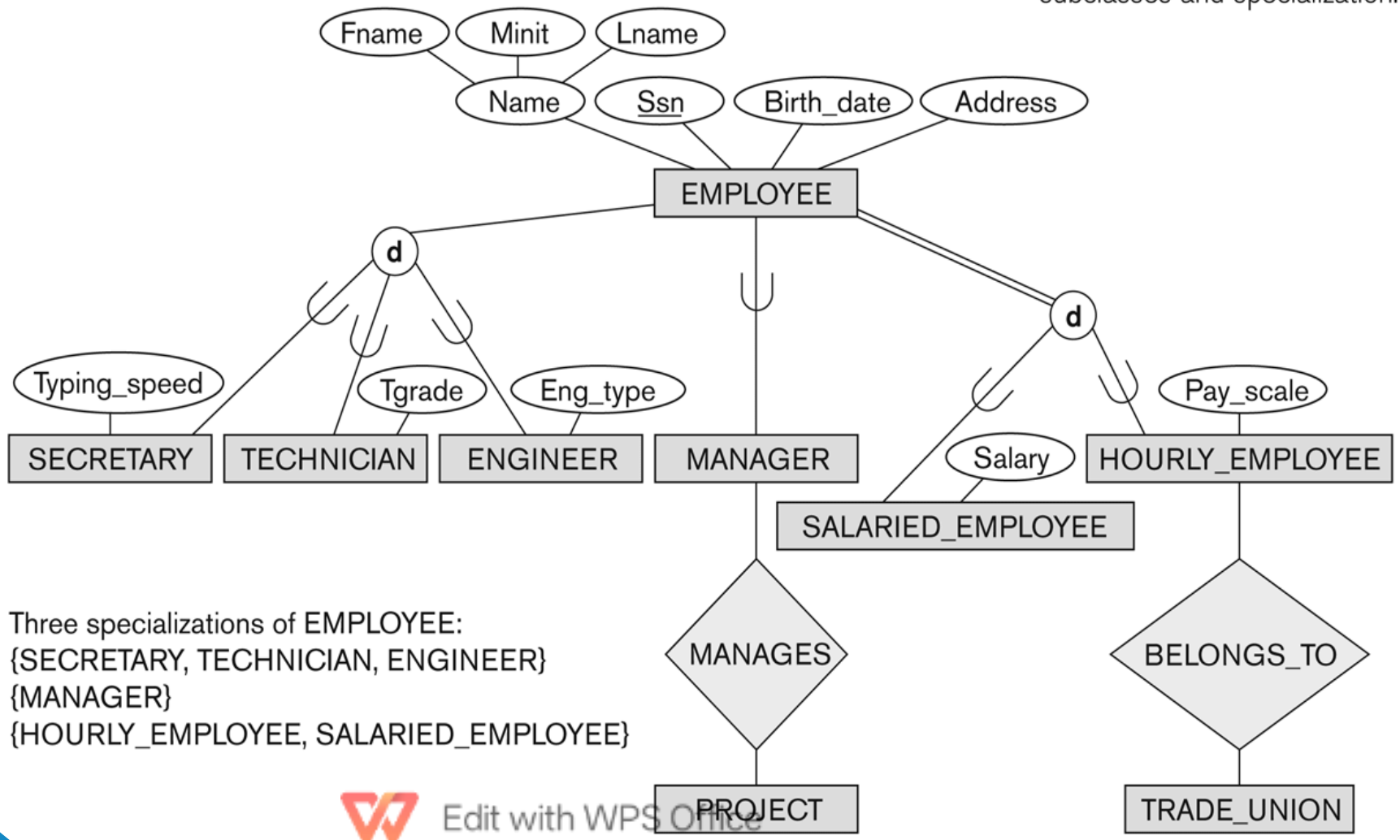
Specialization (2)

- Example: Another specialization of EMPLOYEE based on *method of pay* is {SALARIED_EMPLOYEE, HOURLY_EMPLOYEE}.
  - Superclass/subclass relationships and specialization can be diagrammatically represented in EER diagrams
  - Attributes of a subclass are called *specific* or *local* attributes.
    - For example, the attribute TypingSpeed of SECRETARY
  - The subclass can also participate in specific relationship types.
    - For example, a relationship BELONGS_TO of HOURLY_EMPLOYEE

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Specialization (3)

Figure 4.1
EER diagram notation to represent subclasses and specialization.



Three specializations of EMPLOYEE:
{SECRETARY, TECHNICIAN, ENGINEER}
{MANAGER}
{HOURLY_EMPLOYEE, SALARIED_EMPLOYEE}

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Generalization

- Generalization is the reverse of the specialization process
- Several classes with common features are generalized into a superclass;
  - original classes become its subclasses
- Example: CAR, TRUCK generalized into VEHICLE;
  - both CAR, TRUCK become subclasses of the superclass VEHICLE.
  - We can view {CAR, TRUCK} as a specialization of VEHICLE
  - Alternatively, we can view VEHICLE as a generalization of CAR and TRUCK

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Generalization (2)

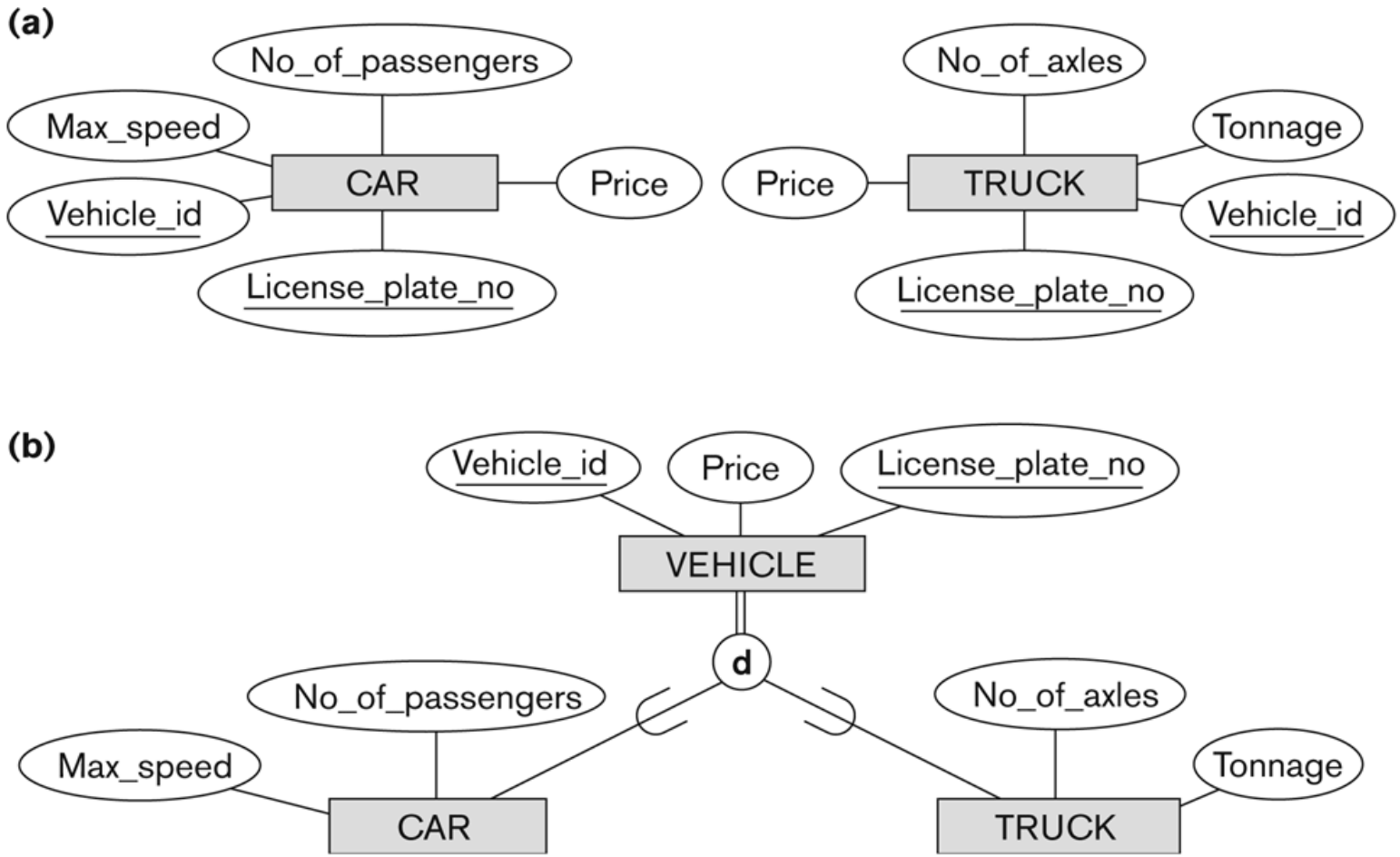


Figure 4.3
Generalization. (a) Two entity types, CAR and TRUCK. (b) Generalizing CAR and TRUCK into the superclass VEHICLE.

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Generalization and Specialization (1)

- Diagrammatic notation are sometimes used to distinguish between generalization and specialization
  - Arrow pointing to the generalized superclass represents a generalization
  - Arrows pointing to the specialized subclasses represent a specialization
  - We *do not use* this notation because it is often subjective as to which process is more appropriate for a particular situation
  - We advocate not drawing any arrows

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Generalization and Specialization (2)

- Data Modeling with Specialization and Generalization
  - A superclass or subclass represents a collection (or set or grouping) of entities
  - It also represents a particular *type of entity*
  - Shown in rectangles in EER diagrams (as are entity types)
  - We can call all entity types (and their corresponding collections) ***classes***, whether they are entity types, superclasses, or subclasses

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Constraints on Specialization and Generalization (1)

- If we can determine exactly those entities that will become members of each subclass by a condition, the subclasses are called predicate-defined (or condition-defined) subclasses
  - Condition is a constraint that determines subclass members
  - Display a predicate-defined subclass by writing the predicate condition next to the line attaching the subclass to its superclass

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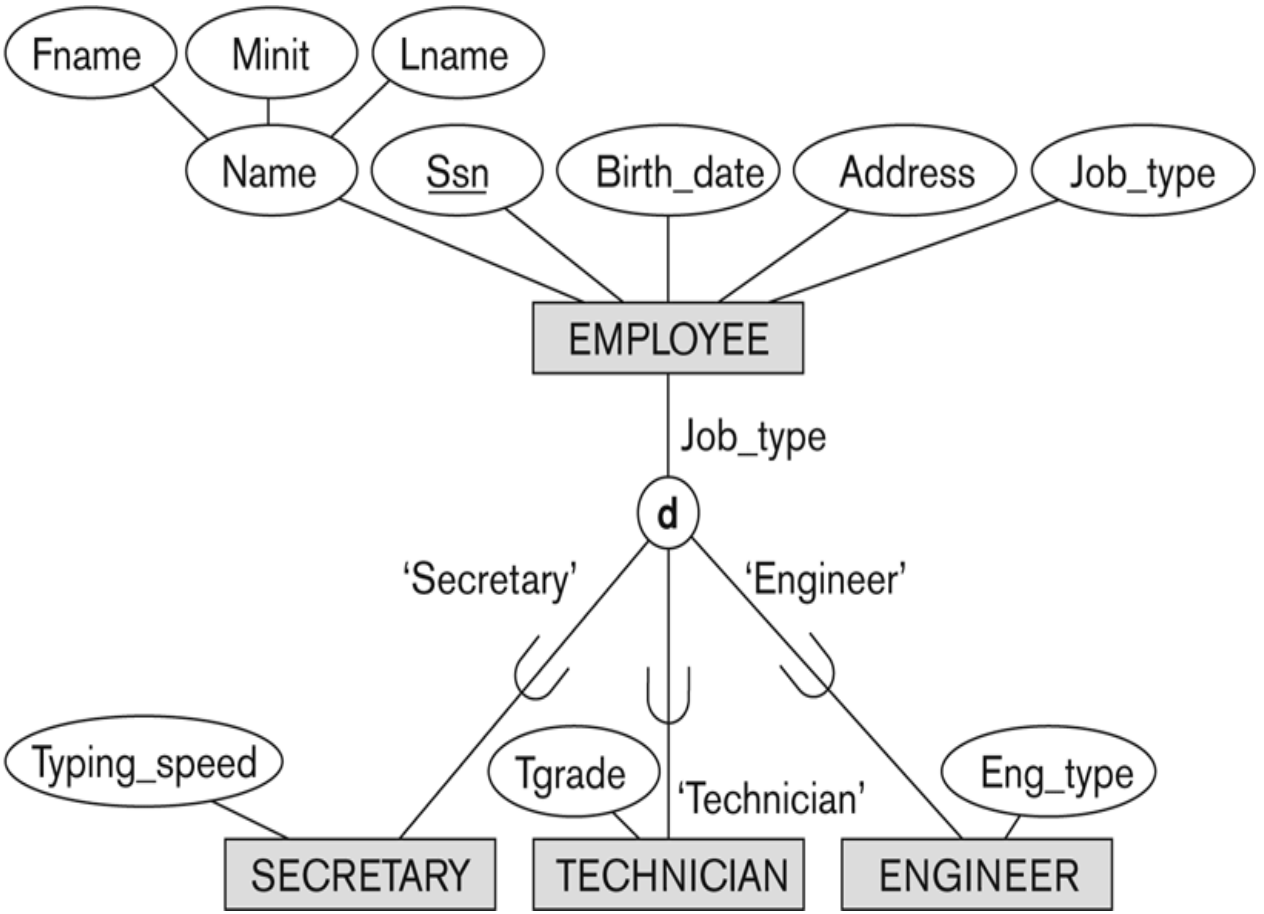
Constraints on Specialization and Generalization (2)

- If all subclasses in a specialization have membership condition on same attribute of the superclass, specialization is called an attribute-defined specialization
  - Attribute is called the defining attribute of the specialization
    - Example: JobType is the defining attribute of the specialization {SECRETARY, TECHNICIAN, ENGINEER} of EMPLOYEE
- If no condition determines membership, the subclass is called user-defined
  - Membership in a subclass is determined by the database users by applying an operation to add an entity to the subclass
  - Membership in the subclass is specified individually for each entity in the superclass by the user

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Displaying an attribute-defined specialization in EER diagrams

Figure 4.4
EER diagram notation for an attribute-defined specialization on Job_type.



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Constraints on Specialization and Generalization (3)

- Two basic constraints can apply to a specialization/generalization:
  - Disjointness Constraint
  - Completeness Constraint

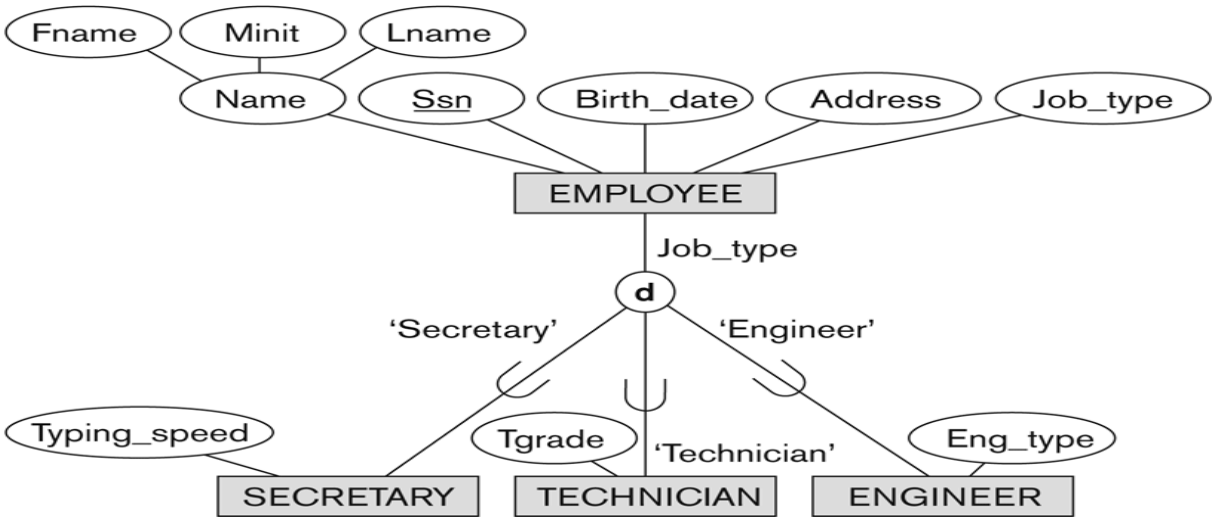
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Constraints on Specialization and Generalization (4)

- Disjointness Constraint:
  - Specifies that the subclasses of the specialization must be *disjoint*:
    - an entity can be a member of at most one of the subclasses of the specialization
  - Specified by ***d*** in EER diagram
  - If not disjoint, specialization is *overlapping*:
    - that is the same entity may be a member of more than one subclass of the specialization
  - Specified by ***o*** in EER diagram

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Figure 4.4
EER diagram notation for an attribute-defined specialization on Job_type.



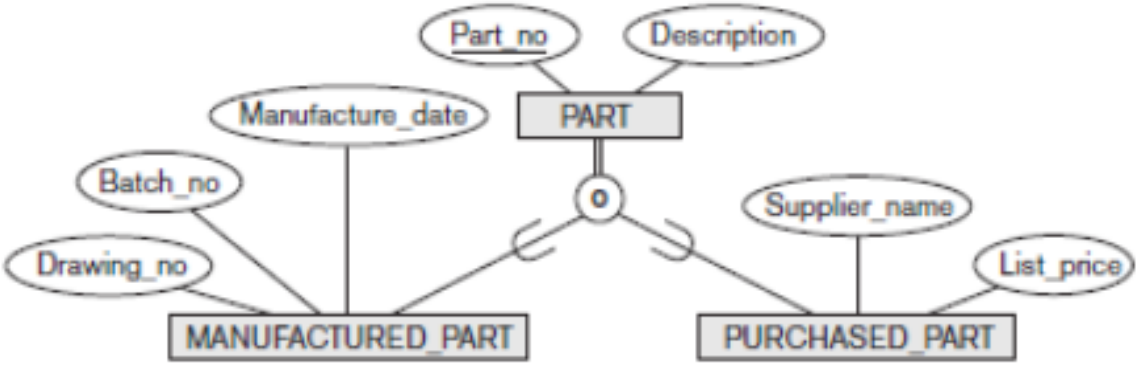


Figure 4.5
EER diagram notation for an overlapping (nondisjoint) specialization.

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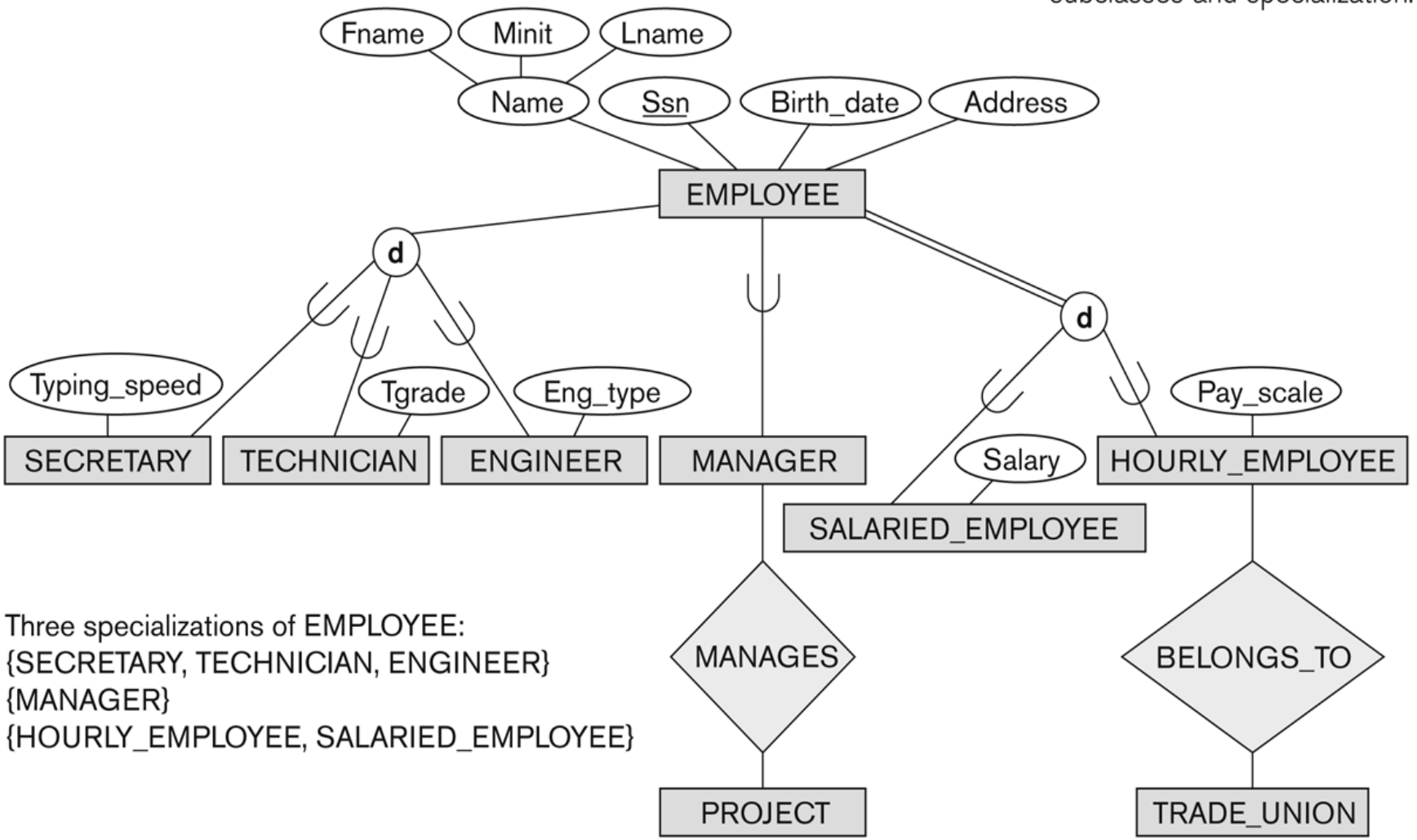
Constraints on Specialization and Generalization (5)

- Completeness Constraint:
  - *Total* specifies that every entity in the superclass must be a member of some subclass in the specialization/generalization
  - Shown in EER diagrams by a ***double line***
  - *Partial* allows an entity not to belong to any of the subclasses
  - Shown in EER diagrams by a single line

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Specialization (3)

Figure 4.1
EER diagram notation to represent subclasses and specialization.



Three specializations of EMPLOYEE:
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{MANAGER}
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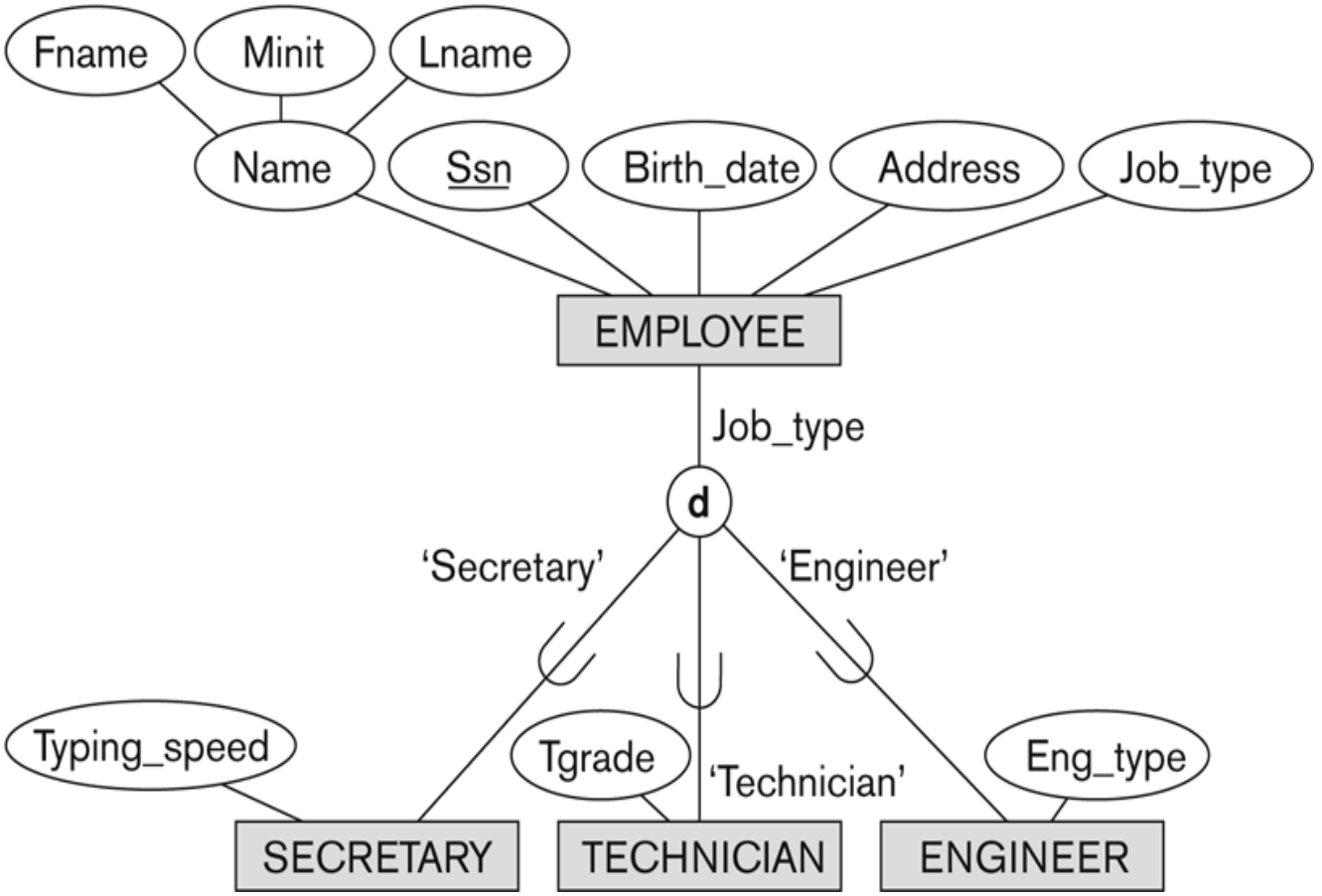
Constraints on Specialization and Generalization (6)

- Hence, we have four types of specialization/generalization:
  - Disjoint, total
  - Disjoint, partial
  - Overlapping, total
  - Overlapping, partial
- Note: Generalization usually is total because the superclass is derived from the subclasses.

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Example of disjoint partial Specialization

Figure 4.4
EER diagram notation for an attribute-defined specialization on Job_type.



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Example of overlapping total Specialization

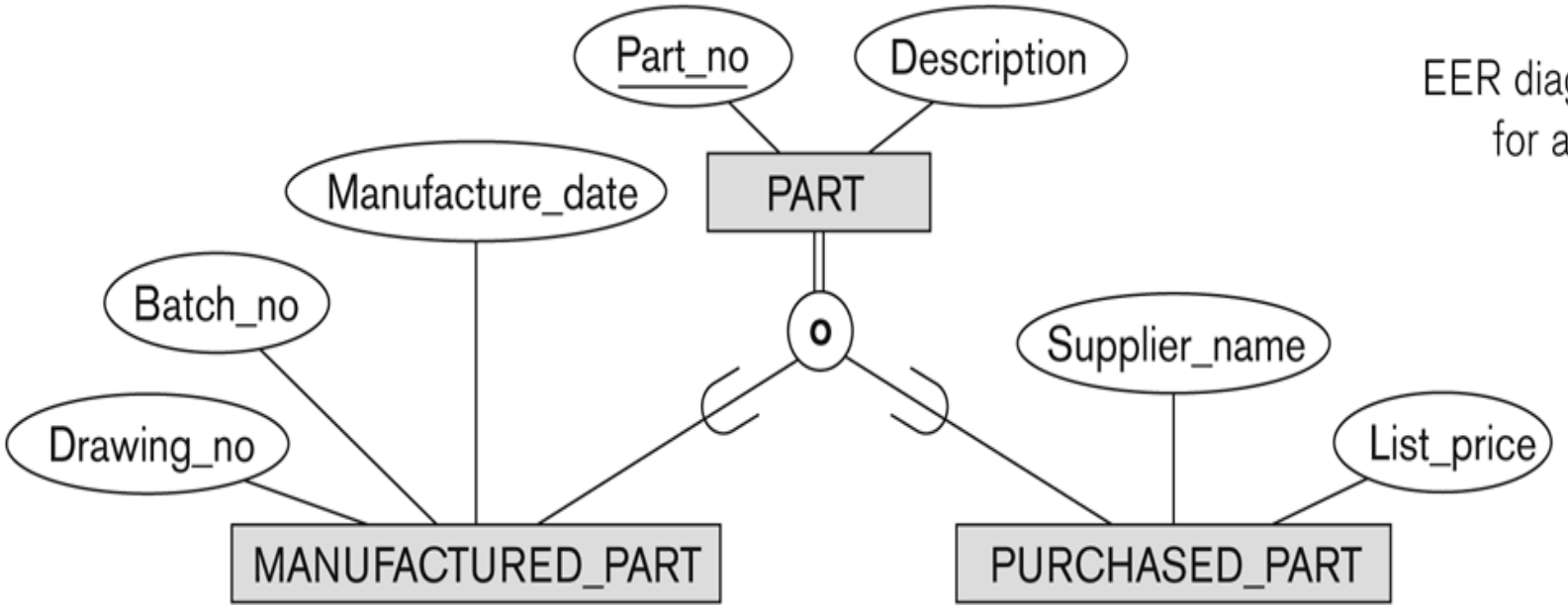


Figure 4.5
EER diagram notation for an overlapping (nondisjoint) specialization.

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Specialization/Generalization Hierarchies, Lattices & Shared Subclasses (1)

- A subclass may itself have further subclasses specified on it
  - forms a hierarchy or a lattice
- ***Hierarchy*** has a constraint that every subclass has only one superclass (called ***single inheritance***); this is basically a ***tree structure***
- In a ***lattice***, a subclass can be subclass of more than one superclass (called ***multiple inheritance***)

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Shared Subclass “Engineering_Manager”

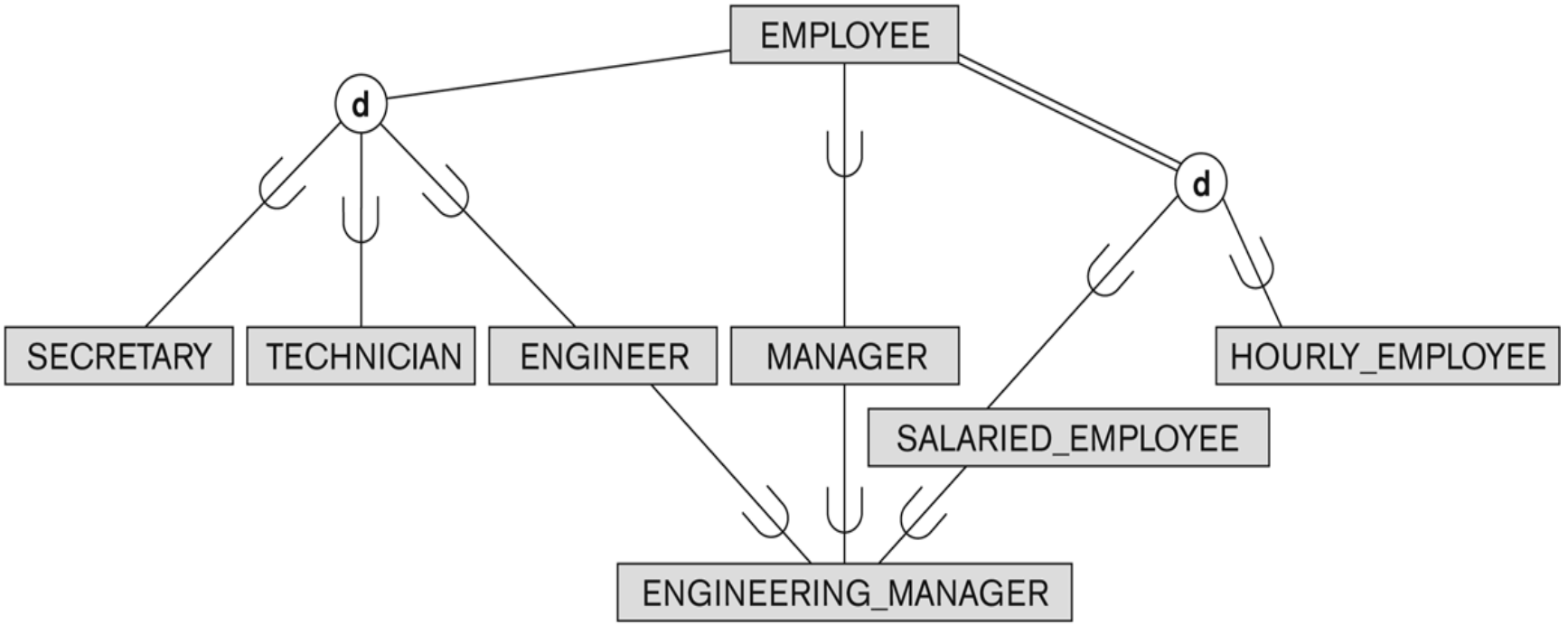


Figure 4.6
A specialization lattice with shared subclass ENGINEERING_MANAGER.

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Specialization/Generalization Hierarchies, Lattices & Shared Subclasses (2)

- In a lattice or hierarchy, a subclass inherits attributes not only of its direct superclass, but also of all its predecessor superclasses
- A subclass with more than one superclass is called a **shared subclass** (multiple inheritance)
- Can have:
  - *specialization* hierarchies or lattices, or
  - *generalization* hierarchies or lattices,
  - depending on how they were *derived*
- We just use *specialization* (to stand for the end result of either specialization or generalization)

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Specialization/Generalization Hierarchies, Lattices & Shared Subclasses (3)

- In *specialization*, start with an entity type and then define subclasses of the entity type by successive specialization
  - **called a *top down* conceptual refinement process**
- In *generalization*, start with many entity types and generalize those that have common properties
  - **Called a *bottom up* conceptual synthesis process**
- In practice, a *combination of both processes* is usually employed

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Specialization / Generalization Lattice Example (UNIVERSITY)

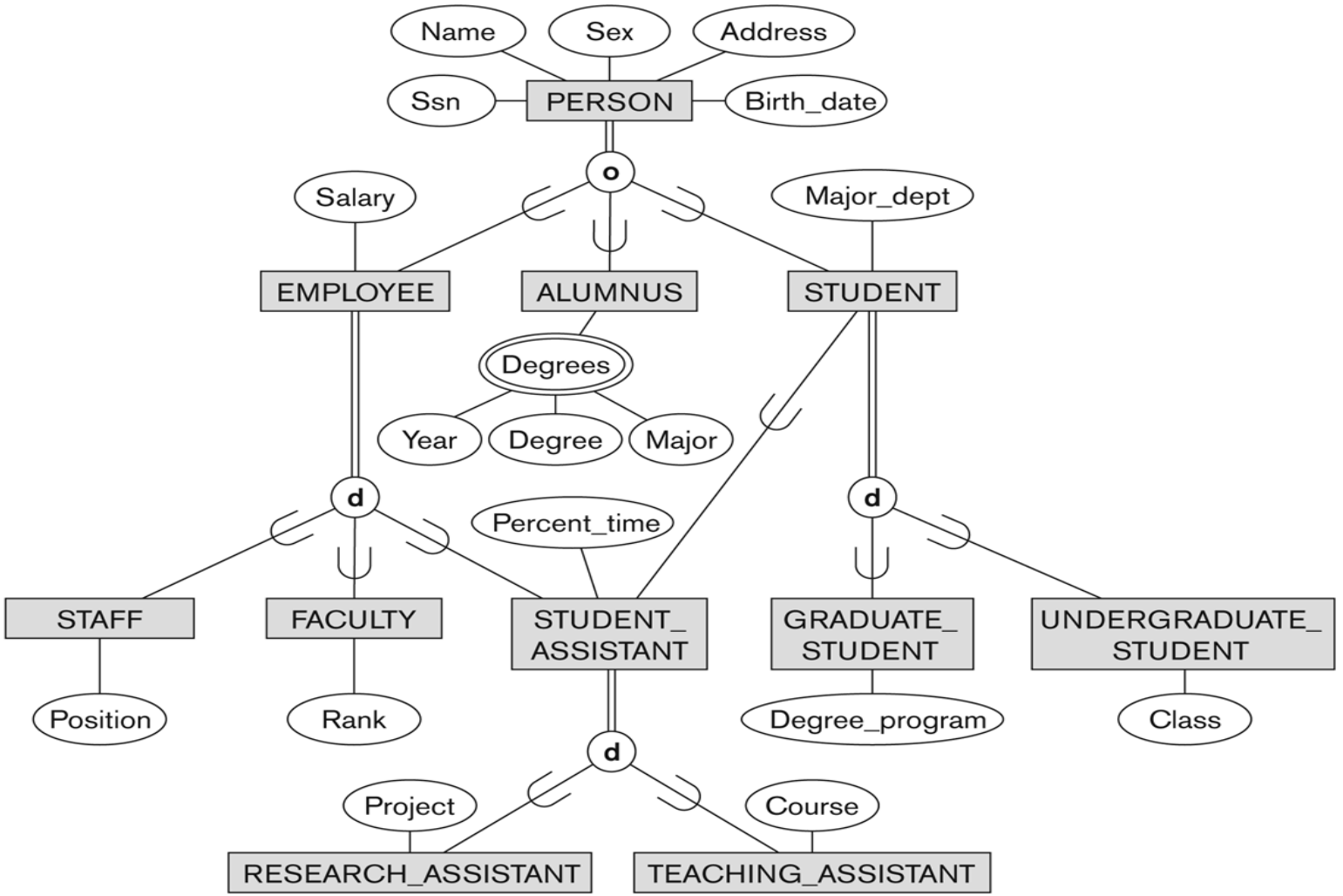


Figure 4.7
A specialization lattice with multiple inheritance for a UNIVERSITY database.

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Categories (UNION TYPES) (1)

- All of the *superclass/subclass relationships* we have seen thus far have a single superclass
- A shared subclass is a subclass in:
  - *more than one* distinct superclass/subclass relationships
  - each relationships has a single superclass
  - shared subclass leads to multiple inheritance
- In some cases, we need to model a *single superclass/subclass relationship* with *more than one* superclass
- Superclasses can represent different entity types Such a
- subclass is called a **category or UNION TYPE**

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Categories (UNION TYPES) (2)

- Example: In a database for vehicle registration, a vehicle owner can be a PERSON, a BANK (holding a lien on a vehicle) or a COMPANY.
  - A *category* (UNION type) called OWNER is created to represent a subset of the *union* of the three superclasses COMPANY, BANK, and PERSON
  - A category member must exist in ***at least one*** of its superclasses
- Difference from *shared subclass*, which is a:
  - subset of the *intersection* of its superclasses
  - shared subclass member must exist in ***all*** of its superclasses

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Two categories (UNION types): OWNER, REGISTERED_VEHICLE

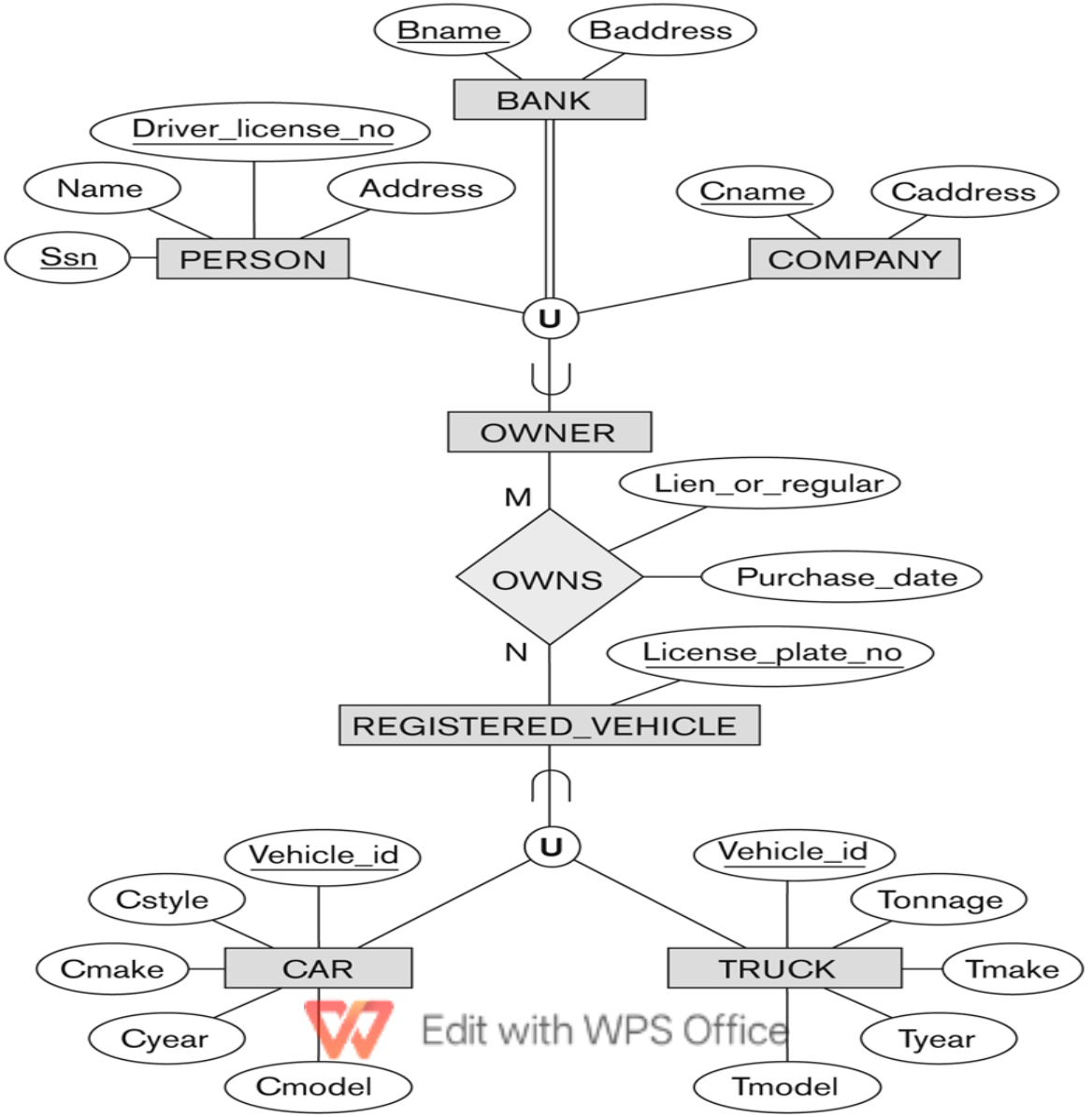


Figure 4.8
Two categories (union types): OWNER and REGISTERED_VEHICLE.

Summary

- Introduced the EER model concepts
  - Class/subclass relationships
  - Specialization and generalization
  - Inheritance
- These augment the basic ER model concepts introduced in Chapter 3
- EER diagrams and alternative notations were presented

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